

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1393

By Vital

A RESOLUTION to honor Robert "Percy" Person on the celebration of his eighty-ninth birthday.

WHEREAS, the members of this General Assembly take great pleasure in paying tribute to a gentleman who has provided excellent service and even better advice to his clients during his distinguished tenure as the proprietor of Percy's Shine Service in downtown Nashville's historic Arcade; and

WHEREAS, while he has owned and operated this particular business for thirty-three years, Robert "Percy" Person has shined more than 500,000 pairs of shoes during the course of his nearly eighty-year career; and

WHEREAS, Percy Person doesn't merely shine shoes; this humorous sage often holds forth on life in a manner that both entertains and enlightens his loyal clientele; and

WHEREAS, Mr. Person began shining shoes in 1948, when he was a tender eleven years of age, to help his single mother make ends meet; and

WHEREAS, in the nearly eight decades since, Percy Person has shined, stained, and repaired the footwear of thousands of politicians, lawyers, business people, and other downtown workers; countless mayors; a few governors; and even select members of the General Assembly; and

WHEREAS, Percy has become an institution in downtown Nashville, tending to his trade with an artistic perfection that has earned him the undisputed title of "King of Shoe Artists"; and

WHEREAS, gifted in his vocation, Percy is an even better Person, often assisting friends who are in need or in trouble; he has bought many bus tickets and much food for those in need; covered the backs of many friends; and served as a mentor to the downtrodden; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that we should pay tribute to the man known to all simply as Percy on this special occasion and thank him for his many contributions to his community and his kind and efficient service to members of the General Assembly and their footwear; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor and congratulate Robert "Percy" Person on the celebration of his eighty-ninth birthday on July 6, 2026, salute his nearly eighty-year career as a shoe artist, and extend to him our best wishes for many happy returns of the day.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.